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Marwari language

Marwari (मारवाड़ी, مارواڑی, *Mārwāṛī*, IPA: [marʋaɽi])[a] is a Western Indo-Aryan language belonging to the Indo-Iranian subdivision of the Indo-European languages. Marwari and its closely related varieties like Dhundhari, Shekhawati and Mewari form a part of the broader Rajasthani language family. It is spoken in the Indian state of Rajasthan, as well as the neighbouring states of Gujarat and Haryana, some adjacent areas in eastern parts of Pakistan, and some migrant communities in Nepal.[4][5][6] There are two dozen varieties of Marwari.

Marwari is popularly written in Devanagari script, as are many languages of India and Nepal, including Hindi, Marathi, Nepali, and Sanskrit; although it was historically written in Mahajani, it is still written in the Perso-Arabic script by the Marwari minority in Eastern parts of Pakistan (the standard/western Naskh script variant is used in Sindh Province, and the eastern Nastalik variant is used in Punjab Province), where it has educational status but where it is rapidly shifting to Urdu.[7]

Marwari has no official status in India and is not used as a language of education. Marwari is still spoken widely in Jodhpur, Pali, Jaisalmer, Barmer, Nagaur, and Bikaner. It is also one of the most common languages spoken by Indians in Kenya.

History

It is believed that Marwari and Gujarati evolved from *Old Western Rajasthani* or *Dingal*.[8] Formal grammar of Gurjar Apabhraṃśa was written by Jain monk and Gujarati scholar Hemachandra Suri.

Marwari

मारवाड़ी

مارواڑی



The word *Marwari* written in Devanagari, Nastaliq, and Mahajani scripts

Pronunciation	[mɑrvɑɽi]
Native to	India · Pakistan
Region	Marwar
Ethnicity	Marwari
Native speakers	21 million, total count (2011 census)[1] (additional speakers counted under Hindi)[2]
Language family	Indo-European ▪ Indo-Iranian ▪ Indo-Aryan

Geographical distribution

Marwari is primarily spoken in the Indian state of Rajasthan. Marwari speakers have dispersed widely throughout India and other countries but are found most notably in the neighbouring state of Gujarat and in Eastern Pakistan. Speakers are also found in Bhopal. With around 7.9 million speakers in India according to the 2001 census.[9]

Some dialects of Marwari are:[10]

Marwari dialects

Dialect	Spoken in
Thali/Bikaneri	Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Phalodi, Balotra districts
Godwari	Jalore, Sirohi, Sanchore, Pali districts
Dhatki	Eastern Sindh and Barmer
Shekhawati	Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Neem ka thana districts
Standard Marwari	Ajmer, Beawer, Jodhpur, Kekri, Nagore

Lexis

Indian Marwari [rwr] in Rajasthan shares a 50%–65% lexical similarity with Hindi (this is based on a Swadesh 210 word list comparison)[11]. It has many cognate words with Hindi. Notable phonetic correspondences include /s/ in Hindi with /h/ in Marwari. For example, /sona/ 'gold' (Hindi) and /hono/ 'gold' (Marwari).

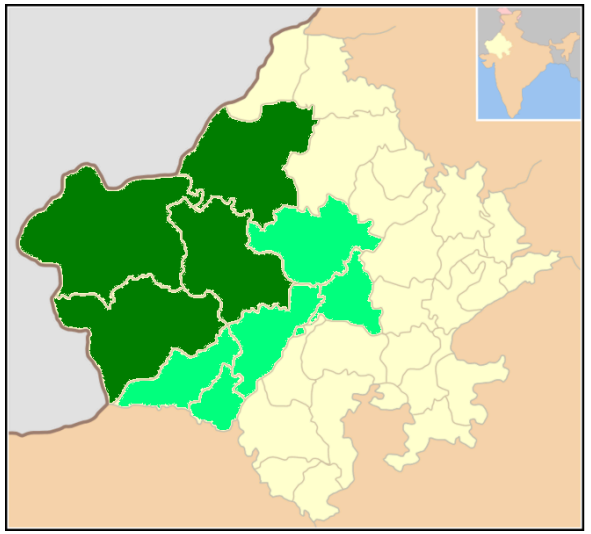
Pakistani Marwari [mve] shares 87% lexical similarity between its Southern subdialects in Sindh (Utradi, Jaxorati, and Larecha) and Northern subdialects in Punjab (Uganyo, Bhattipo, and Khadali), 79%–83% with Dhakti [mki], and 78% with Meghwar and Bhat Marwari dialects. Mutual intelligibility of Pakistani Marwari [mve] with Indian Marwari [rwr] is decreasing due to the rapid shift of active speakers in Pakistan to Urdu, their use of the Arabic script and different sources of

- Western[3]
- Rajasthani
- **Marwari**

Writing system	Devanagari (in India) Nastaliq (in Pakistan) Mahajani (historical)
Language codes	
ISO 639-2	mwr (https://www.loc.gov/standards/iso639-2/php/langcodes_name.php?code_ID=310)
ISO 639-3	mwr – inclusive code Individual codes: dhd – Dhundari rwr – Marwari (India) mve – Bahawali wry – Merwari mtr – Mewari swv – Shekhawati
Glottolog	*None* raja1256 (https://glottolog.org/resource/languoid/id/raja1256) scattered in Rajasthani

support medias, and their separation from Indian Marwaris, even if there are some educational efforts to keep it active (but absence of official recognition by Pakistani or provincial government level). Many words have been borrowed from other Pakistani languages.[7]

Merwari [wry] shares 82%–97% intelligibility of Pakistani Marwari [mve], with 60%–73% lexical similarity between Merwari varieties in Ajmer and Nagaur districts, but only 58%–80% with Shekhawati [swv], 49%–74% with Indian Marwari [rwr], 44%–70% with Godwari [gdx], 54%–72% with Mewari [mtr], 62%–70% with Dhundari [dhd], 57%–67% with Haroti [hoj]. Unlike Pakistani Marwari [mve], the use of Merwari remains vigorous, even if its most educated speakers also proficiently speak Hindi [hin].[12]



Dark green indicates Marwari speaking home area in Rajasthan, light green indicates additional dialect areas where speakers identify their language as Marwari.



Geographical distribution of Rajasthani languages

Marwari Dialects Comparison

Dialect	Lexical Similarity with Hindi	Phonetic Correspondences
Indian Marwari [rwr]	50%–65%	Notable: /s/ in Hindi → /h/ in Marwari (e.g., /sona/ 'gold' → /hono/ 'gold')
Pakistani Marwari [mve]	87% (Southern Sindh) / 79%–83% (Dhakti [mki]) / 78% (Meghwar, Bhat Marwari)	Mutual intelligibility decreasing due to shifts in Pakistan
Merwari [wry]	82%–97% (with Pakistani Marwari [mve]) / 60%–73% (Ajmer, Nagaur)	58%–80% (Shekhawati [swv]) / 49%–74% (Indian Marwari [rwr]) / 44%–70% (Godwari [gdx]) / 54%–72% (Mewari [mtr]) / 62%–70% (Dhundari [dhd]) / 57%–67% (Haroti [hoj])
Merwari [wry] vs. Pakistani Marwari [mve]	Intelligibility: 82%–97%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Indian Marwari [rwr]	Intelligibility: 49%–74%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Shekhawati [swv]	Intelligibility: 58%–80%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Godwari [gdx]	Intelligibility: 44%–70%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Mewari [mtr]	Intelligibility: 54%–72%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Dhundari [dhd]	Intelligibility: 62%–70%	
Merwari [wry] vs. Haroti [hoj]	Intelligibility: 57%–67%	



A man speaking Marwari.

Phonology

Vowels[13]

	Front	Central	Back
Close	i		u
	ɪ		ʊ
Mid	e	ə	o
	ɛ		ɔ
Open		ä	

- Nasalization of vowels is phonemic, all of the vowels can be nasalized.[13]
- Diphthongs are /ai, ia, ae, əi, ei, oi, ui, ua, uo/[13]

Consonants[13]

		Labial	Dental/ Alveolar	Retroflex	Post-alv/ Palatal	Velar	Glottal
Nasal		m	n	ɳ		ŋ	
Plosive/ Affricate	**voiceless**	p	t	ʈ	t͡ɕ	k	
	aspirated	pʰ	tʰ	ʈʰ	t͡ɕʰ	kʰ	
	voiced	b	d	ɖ	d͡ʑ	g	
	breathy	bʱ	dʱ	ɖʱ	d͡ʑʱ	gʱ	
	implosive	ɓ	ɗ				
Fricative			s				h
Sonorant	**rhotic**		r	ɽ			
	lateral	w	l	ɭ	j		

- Implosives are mostly only found word initially and it formed due to the influence of neighbouring languages.[13]
- /w/ is [ʊ] before front vowels and [w] elsewhere e.g. [ʊɪwwa] 'marriage'.[14]